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2/21/01 - OHATS Improvement Specs.

Hi Dan,

Please give me some feedback on what is useful in the following before we do a live practice version on the web. Rather than putting these changes in a web page format (as I did earlier), I'm listing only the content. Then I'll make it look and feel as close as possible to the current version of OHATS.

Please add your comments and feedback throughout this document.

The idea is to have 6 types of data tables. Data across the tables is connected to each other (that is all the information is in one relational database). For each type of table there are forms that let users enter new information, view and edit it, search for and sort by specific information, and run a few pre-formatted reports.

Table 1: Recorders

This table collects data describing our recorders (you, me, ...). Some things to include here: Name; Organization(s); City

Role with Cabrini Connections and/or T/MC

1) Active in a committee

- recruitment
- conference
- technology
- public awareness
- research
- other

2) Active networker/collaborator, but not formally T/MC partner

3) CC Staff

4) CC volunteer (advisor, director, tutor/mentor)

Any contact information that would be included in the Contacts table (If a potential recorder is already in our Contacts table they will have to fill in less information.)

I suggest a "first time entry option for recorders". This should only be for "new" people who do not receive one of the Cabrini Connections newsletters in the mail.

First Name

Last Name

Main Phone

Fax

Email

Title

Organization

Mailing address (Street Apt City Zip Country)

Role with Cabrini Connections and/or T/MC

Active in a committee (a definition of the goals of each committee could be some where on the site to show what participation in this area is intended to accomplish. Any time someone clicks that committee, he/she'd be supporting that definition of objectives)

- recruitment
- conference
- technology
- public awareness
- resource development

- research
- Kids' Connection (hitting this goes to a separate input screen)
- other

Active networker/collaborator, but not formally
T/MC partner

Table 2: People & Organizations

This table can (since I have not constructed it yet) collect any information that would describe and allow us to contact people. There are several types of software that already do this (as you know) and some can be connected with the ACCESS database. I'd like to avoid re-developing software, so until we get the funds to connect the T/MC contacts database more formally, for now we can collect or upload from your existing database some basics: name, organization, email address, and any other info that you'd say is especially important for OHATS.

I'd like to be developing an email list that enables us to mail information about everything we do, or just about one of the focus areas: I'd want to be using this as it develops. I'd also like the software/thinking behind it to lead to the development of online newsletters and invitations.

- recruitment
- conference
- technology
- public awareness
- resource development
- research
- other

Table 3: Contacts Log (this really is where a recorder begins to enter data in the form, doesn't it?)

This table collects information on the

- 1) Person and/or organization that we contacted
- 2) Relationship
- 3) First time, on-going?

We need to have Who we're contacting and a way to enter address and email information when we enter this for the first time. This should only be for "new" contacts. Filling out anything beyond name/organization would be optional. We won't always know any more.

First Name

Last Name

Main Phone

Fax

Email

Title

Organization

Mailing address (Street Apt City Zip Country

Role with Cabrini Connections and/or T/MC

Active in a committee (a definition of the goals of each committee could be some where on the site to show what participation in this area is intended to accomplish. Any time someone clicks that committee, he/she'd be supporting that definition of objectives)

- recruitment
- conference

- technology
- public awareness
- resource development
- research
- Kids' Connection (hitting this goes to a separate input screen)
- other

Active networker/collaborator, but not formally
T/MC partner

4) Method of contact (pop up)

In person

Phone

Email

Listserv (local, national (Benton, Mott, abcd, MentorNet, other (as "other" gets added 10 or more times, it gets adds to list of pop up choices)

Newletter

T/MC Conference

Other

The Contacts Log is meant to be the quick way for you to catch the constant outreach and relationship building so that we can track the pattern of how people and organizations come into the T/MC process and T/MC into their environments.

While capturing "who, when and what" someone was contacted for is good, it is too time consuming for most people. I thinking making it easy to enter this information is an important start, but in my experience with designing and seeing people use tracking systems most people will not track this information. If they do, it may be in their daily planner or calendar and they do not want to re-enter that information somewhere else. The advanced tech folks will have daily contact logs in their Palm handheld planner, which in the future may make it easier to track these things. For example, we could (I would really like to if you'd go for it) buy you a Palm and put the OHATS system on it and then you can enter things as you go. This would automatically be connected to your address book. I have the tools to do this and would cost us another \$400. But you need to learn how to use the device (not that hard). Then, at the end of each day, you could "hotsync" with your computer and via the Internet your OHATS information would come to our website. When I have the money, I'll do this. I don't have the money.

Now all this said, the value of tracking contacts alone is not as powerful (and people are not inclined to track them) without some other information that the recorder considers important about the specific contact. I realize this is biased and that it is difficult for us to predict ahead of time what may be the real importance of a give contact (meeting or phone call). But even a little bit of "imagination" of what might be the result or the wish for a future result is very helpful for making sense of the value of the specific contact.

Steve, our contacts should show two things

- a) it is intended to influence something
- b) something happened that is intended to influence overall mission. (Pat Dowdle would probably call these process benchmarks). Only over time, as we enter "what happened/result" will be be able to look back and show an accumulated weight of result (b) as a ratio to the greater accumulation of influences (a)

By putting in the descriptions for recruitment, training, pr, resource building, we show that we WISH for the same thing with each action and contact. We don't need to rewrite that wish. We do need to document things which show how we're getting there (a) and milestones along the way (b).

I've already learned that every action causes an effect. However, I cannot document that. This system should not only show that, but should teach the relationship of consistent actions to consistent effects.

This entry intended to

- a) document contact intended to move CC or T/MC mission forward
- b) document confirmed event/action (if this is selected, go straight to the enter result field)

5) This contact intended to "influence" (keeping in mind that we've already defined what we mean by influence recruitment) . Should each of these have a "What happened option that ties to the "result" table (area #6)?

- all of these areas
- recruitment
- training/conference
- technology
- enhance public awareness. Increase reach and frequency of "message" delivery (pop up radio, tv, newspaper, magazine, Internet)
- increase links to T/MC web site, and thus visits to T/MC site (and use of T/MC information)
- Kids' Connection (hitting this goes to a separate input screen)
- conduct/support research or outreach
- broker/build support from influential people
- broker/build physical or financial resources for other programs/networks in addition to T/MC
- broker/build resources for CC and/or T/MC
- provide formal training/development opportunity(ies) (pop up: new program, new network, existing program, existing network)
- provide networking opportunity(ies) (pop up: new program, new network, existing program, existing network)
- start new practice/policy/way of doing business (pop up: new program, new network, existing program, existing network)
- enhance existing practice/policy/way of doing business (pop up: new program, new network, existing program, existing network)
- provide other incentives for change (pop up: new program, new network, existing program, existing network)
- remove other barriers and disincentives for change (pop up: new program, new network, existing program, existing network)

While this is not always necessary to do, the contacts log includes prompts of potential "results" of a contact. "Potential" and "actual" results may also be interpreted "purpose" and "outcome" of the contact, respectively. After the list of potential and actual results, there is a "text" section that allows for further description (only if necessary).

Based on the original OHATS and the entries you've made in the last 3 months, here are descriptions of the most common and valued "types" of potential and actual results of T/MC. Each line is a separate "result" (the bold letters only serve to categorize them and help the user find something). For each results, the user can "check" at least 2 things: scale (in Chicago, in Illinois, out of state, national, global, all of the above) and potential/occurred. There is blank space so if the user wants they can enter the potential or predicted date a result may occur. *Dan, if you want we can add a check box for selecting the major 4 T/MC areas of focus (public awareness, resource building, training and research).*

(comments in parenthesis describe additional information the user can enter)
What happened during this contact? (for all items that apply please "check" a response for its scale and its occurrence)

Steve, is what follows a table describing what we've listed from point 1 to 5 above?

1 Contact info 2-4 Relationship: start new build ongoing (collaboration?) advance to new level Program or Service: start new improve existing (I don't think we need this since it will be reflected in purpose of contact) 5) Purpose of contact: see list of influences (above) Enter result field (each influence in area 5 could have a corresponding result area) -New website or link: [http://give name] -New conference supporter -New recruitment campaign supporter Adoption/replication of T/MC approach Request: funding [\$ value = _____] specific support [\$ value = _____] support in general a specific action Receive:funding [\$ value = _____] specific support [\$ value = _____] endorsement/support in general training/education a specific action Inform/Consult: to specific program or group to a general audience Every contact informs or consults, formally and informally. When we list who we contacted we complete the entry for this area.	Community Infrastructure: (see my list of intended influence) enhance public awareness conduct/support research or outreach broker/build support from influential people broker/build physical or financial resources provide formal training/development opportunity(ies) provide networking opportunity(ies) start new practice/policy/way of doing business enhance existing practice/policy/way of doing business provide other incentives for change remove other barriers and disincentives for change Event outside of our control [_ positive _ negative] The result of almost everything we do is out of our control, but it is all within our influence. As we grow we'll show that our actions result in greater influence. I'm not sure we need this as a separate entry. We need to look for it as a result. Ripple-Effect (result of other org due to T/MC support) This is the same as above. The result of almost everything we do creates a ripple effect. As we grow we'll show that our actions result in greater influence. As more people from more places enter into OHATS, or attend a conference, participate in recruitment, and/or log in on the web site guest book, we'll see an expanding influence pattern. I'm not sure we need this as a separate entry. We need to look for it as a result. Other (describe below)
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Dan, this table is only slightly different for the table that collects "other outcomes and results." That table has these extra items:

Planning session for TMC / KC / CC
Hire staff of TMC / KC / CC

Now that I think of it, we probably do not need 2 separate tables (contacts log and the other outcomes and results). That is in one "form" you can choose to only fill out contact information. Then, if needed, you fill out any very specific results or leave them blank if it was a general contact. There is always the opportunity to describe what happened in text.

Please comment on what in the table should be revised, deleted and added.

In addition, the following prompts are at the bottom of the forms for the "contacts log" and the "other outcomes and results:"

Details of result(s):		Specific lesson(s) / idea(s):	
Specific follow-up date:	mm/dd/yyyy		
Specific follow-up information:			
Use in future:		☐ newsletter ☐ report/presentation ☐ other	
Delete and Start New		Submit Information	Submit & Email Information

Other tables in the new OHATS:

Services Log: tracks number of people attended, location, date(s), purpose and "other" for a pull down list of CC services (conference, recruitment fair, KCC events, what ever you want to add to the list

Media Log: tracks type, location, value, date(s), and other specifics you'd like about print, tv, radio, and other media. (should the web be here too?) This is good. We should be able to edit this with updated information at a later date. For instance. I could enter, TV story on WGN, but would not no circulation information. Later research might fill that in.

I look forward to your feedback,
 Steve